

## ▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **DENTIST** *see pp. 282–283*
- ▶ **OPHTHALMOLOGIST** Diagnoses, treats, and prevents eye diseases. Ophthalmologists are medical doctors who carry out eye surgery in hospital eye departments, as well as in outpatient units and private laser-eye-surgery clinics.
- ▶ **OPTICIAN** Fits and supplies glasses and contact lenses according to prescriptions written by optometrists. Dispensing opticians also order and manage a range of optical products, and help customers to choose frames for glasses.
- ▶ **VISION THERAPIST** Investigates, diagnoses, and treats any abnormalities in eye movement and eye function.

## SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent communication skills for explaining treatments to patients and answering their queries.



Flexibility to adapt to advances in optometric practice, such as improved scientific techniques.



Strong interpersonal skills to liaise with and put patients at ease, and interact with colleagues.



The ability to analyze scientific and mathematical data, and to diagnose patients accurately.



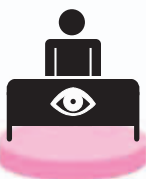
Good manual dexterity for using sophisticated optometric equipment correctly.



Concentration, precision, and attention to detail for examining patients' eyesight accurately.

### PRIVATE PRACTICE

**OWNER** Oversees the running of an optometry practice, managing the business, recruiting staff, and ordering stock, often in addition to seeing patients.



**OPTOMETRIST** You will need to undertake continued training in order to have your professional license renewed each year. You can specialize in a particular area (such as children or partially sighted patients), work in a shop or hospital, or open your own clinic.



### CONSULTANT (HOSPITAL)

**OPTOMETRIST** Assesses, treats, and monitors patients suffering from sight loss or complex or serious eye conditions. The role also involves helping patients in their rehabilitation following surgery or disease.



### OPTICAL DESIGN CONSULTANT

Works with technologists in the optical manufacturing industry, helping to shape the design of glasses, contact lenses, and optical products for other purposes, such as telescopes or scanning systems.